

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3
 ♥ 8 2
 ♦ 10 9 5 4 2
 ♣ K 8 6 3

♠ K 10 7 5

♥ 6

♦ K 8 3

♣ Q J 9 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6 4

♥ K 10 9 7 4 3

♦ A Q 7

♣ A 10

♠ A Q J 8 2

♥ A Q J 5

♦ J 6

♣ 7 4

West	North	East	South
		1♥	1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

[showcards W:H8 N:H6]

The bidding has been as shown. North's 2♥ bid shows good ♠ support with at least 10 points.

Partner led the ♥8, dummy played the ♥6

Play a small ♥.

Partner's ♥8 lead is a high spot card, either top-of-nothing, or a singleton or doubleton. He definitely does not have an honor, which means that South holds ♥ A Q J.

In other words, your ♥K is dead in the water. BUT, if you play it to this trick you hand South three ♥ tricks, while if you play a low ♥ he can only get 2 winners in the suit.

The extra winner would permit South to discard 2 of dummy's ♦ losers, and this would give South the contract.

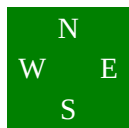
Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 6 4
 ♥ Q J 10 5 3
 ♦ 8 5
 ♣ A 10 4

♠ K 7 3
 ♥ 9 6 4
 ♦ K J 6
 ♣ K J 9 5



♠ J 9 8 5
 ♥ K 7
 ♦ 9 7 4 3
 ♣ 8 7 2

♠ A 10 2
 ♥ A 8 2
 ♦ A Q 10 2
 ♣ Q 6 3

West	North	East	South
			1NT

Pass 3NT
 All Pass

3NT by South
 on the ♥Q, then again on trick two when you play the ♥K. AND HE WILL STILL HAVE HIS ♥A when you switch to another suit. He will have time to drive out the ♣A while he still has ♥s stopped.

It was a good thing you held the ♥K rather than declarer, but it is a nuisance that you must get out of the way on the very first trick.

[showcards W:HQ N:H4]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥Q, dummy played the ♥4

Play the ♥K.

Admittedly you have a terrible hand. But that's no reason to be careless. **YOU** can beat this contract, but you have to do it right now by unblocking the ♥K. If declarer holds up you will continue with your ♥7 and partner will establish his suit while he still has the ♣A for an entry. If declarer doesn't hold up it will be just as bad for him.

But suppose you say "Well, partner's ♥Q is just as good as my ♥K so I'll just save the King for later" as you play low. Declarer will love you. He will hold up ♥A when you switch to another suit. He will have time to drive out the ♣A while he still has ♥s stopped.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 3
♥ J 9 6 2
♦ A 7 3
♣ Q 10 8

♠ A Q J 10 7

♥ A 5

♦ K 4 2

♣ A J 2



♠ K 6 2

♥ K Q 3

♦ 10 9 8 5

♣ 9 7 3

♠ 5 4

♥ 10 8 7 4

♦ Q J 6

♣ K 6 5 4

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

Pass

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South